

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1650

By Cochran

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Community Action Group of Englewood on the fortieth anniversary of Englewood June Days.

WHEREAS, it is our pleasure to recognize those institutions that enrich communities, serve as cultural touchstones, and contribute to the enduring legacy of the great cities that comprise the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, one such organization is the Community Action Group of Englewood, which will commemorate the fortieth anniversary of Englewood June Days in 2026, marking four decades of honoring this State's rich and diverse heritage and culture; and

WHEREAS, with historic buildings lining Main Street, a silver water tower gracing the skyline, and residents who knew each other by name, the Town of Englewood embodied all the quintessential charms of small-town America, except for one thing: an annual festival; and

WHEREAS, that missing piece finally fell into place in 1986, when communities across Tennessee organized celebrations and festivals in honor of Tennessee Homecoming '86; and

WHEREAS, according to the University of Tennessee's Special Collections, the Homecoming '86 initiative was designed to give "Tennesseans an opportunity to rediscover their past, identify the uniqueness of their own communities, and invite other Tennesseans to celebrate with them"; and

WHEREAS, in partnership with the statewide initiative, Englewood Mayor Bob Middleton appointed Marion Cochran, a retired local school teacher, to chair the Homecoming '86 Planning Committee; Mrs. Cochran assembled a group of Englewood residents and organized a celebration in late June, featuring softball games, class reunions, and a banquet for former Englewood High School students; and

WHEREAS, the week's events culminated with a grand festival on Saturday, followed by a community-wide church service on Sunday; the festival featured a pancake breakfast, bluegrass and country music, arts and crafts exhibits, and a square dance on Main Street; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Homecoming '86 proved a resounding success in Englewood, drawing hundreds of former and current residents who gathered to celebrate their town's rich heritage and savor the fellowship of old friends; and

WHEREAS, due to the overwhelmingly positive response, the Homecoming Planning Committee saw no reason for the celebration to end after one year, so when the last weekend of June 1987 rolled around, the citizens of Englewood gathered once again to hold their newly established annual festival, June Days; and

WHEREAS, nearly four decades since Homecoming '86, the celebration endures in Englewood; although some still affectionately call the festival June Days, it is now often called Englewood Celebrates, and it proudly stands as one of the last surviving Homecoming '86 events; and

WHEREAS, the Homecoming '86 Planning Committee eventually became the charter members of a local nonprofit organization known as the Community Action Group of Englewood, commonly referred to as CAGE; and

WHEREAS, today, CAGE is headquartered in historic Downtown Englewood, and the organization continues its mission of preserving and promoting Englewood's unique heritage through the operation of the Englewood Textile and History Museum and numerous community events, such as Englewood Celebrates, that it organizes each year; and

WHEREAS, staying true to its roots, Englewood Celebrates closely resembles the festival begun nearly forty years ago; pancakes are still served on Saturday morning as the sound of local bluegrass wafts through the town streets, and come sundown, Main Street closes to traffic as hundreds flock to Downtown Englewood for the evening dance; and

WHEREAS, Englewood Celebrates also boasts new attractions, including a motorcycle show and poker run, an antique tractor show, and numerous food and craft vendors; and

WHEREAS, community pride is palpable in Englewood; it has been prominently on display for four decades now through a homecoming celebration that has become a tradition and a small group of active citizens who have become a safeguard of local heritage; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we recognize CAGE and Englewood June Days on this most auspicious occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the Community Action Group of Englewood on the fortieth anniversary of Englewood June Days, extending our sincere gratitude for the good work of this organization and our best wishes for its continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.